

Careers & Employability EST – Question Decoder

VTCS Method (Very Tired Career Students):

V – Verb: What does the question want you to do?

T – Topic: What concept are you writing about?

C – Context: What situation does it apply to? (Words from the SCSA GTCEM - GLOSSARY OF TERMS)

S – Structure: Use the correct answer formula.

★ Add Because → For example → As a result for stronger answers.

Command Verb	What the Examiner Wants	Structure	Sentence Starters	Example Question & Answer (VTCS highlighted)
Identify / State 1 mark per point 1 sentence	Name the correct item.	Name the item	One example is ____	Identify one element of a cover letter . Answer: One element of a cover letter is contact information.
Outline 2 marks 2 sentences	Brief explanation of a concept.	1. What it is 2. Key feature	____ refers to ____ It involves ____	Outline the concept of a megatrend . Answer: A megatrend refers to a long-term global change that influences society and work.
Describe 1 mark per feature 2–3 sentences	Provide features or characteristics.	Feature Feature Feature	One feature is ____ Another feature is ____	Describe two ways to show initiative in a work environment . Answer: One way is being proactive where employees complete tasks without being asked. Another way is identifying improvements.
Explain 3 marks 3 sentences	Show cause and effect.	Point Why / How Result	One impact of ____ is ____ This occurs because ____ As a result ____	Explain the impact of megatrends on career development . Answer: Megatrends change job types and required skills because industries evolve. As a result individuals must develop new skills.
Discuss 4 marks 4 sentences	Developed explanation with example.	Point Explanation Example Result	One important factor is ____ For example ____ As a result ____	Discuss the influence of impactful technology on the future of work . Answer: Technology automates tasks because digital systems improve efficiency. For example automated software completes repetitive work. As a result workers must upskill.
Compare 3–4 marks	Show similarities and differences.	Similarity Similarity Difference	Both ____ and ____ However ____	Compare two occupations from the research data. Answer: Both occupations require training. However electricians require vocational qualifications whereas directors require a degree.
Analyse 4–5 marks	Interpret data and reach a conclusion.	Evidence Explanation Conclusion	The data shows ____ This indicates ____ Therefore ____	Analyse Amelia's research data to determine the most secure career . Answer: The data shows physiotherapists have strong employment growth. This indicates high demand. Therefore physiotherapy is the most secure path.